

Daniel Park

Fayston Preparatory School, Suji Campus | Class of 2028
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ABOUT

I want to be a mechanical engineer who can also build with AI instead of handing that part to somebody else. In a few years AI will sit inside almost every field, and I think the people who move those fields forward will be the ones who know the field and know the tools well enough to point them at a real problem. Mechanical engineering is the foundation I trust, because loads, tolerances and materials do not care what you meant to do.

EDUCATION

Fayston Preparatory School, Suji Campus

Suji, South Korea

Grade 11, Class of 2028

Mar. 2024 – Present

- Planning to study mechanical engineering, with mathematics, physics and astronomy as the areas I spend the most time on outside class.

ENGINEERING, MATH AND SCIENCE

Fayston Engineering Club

Dec. 2025 – Present

Member, about 1 hour per week

2nd place, Fayston Engineering Competition

- Weekly build sessions. We are handed a written prompt and have to turn it into something that actually works. Sketch, cut, test it, find out why it broke, cut again.
- Placed 2nd at the Fayston Engineering Competition against teams from across the school.
- The useful part was learning to change a design after it failed instead of defending the version I had already drawn.

Mathematics Club

Mar. 2024 – Jun. 2025

Member, about 1 hour per week

2nd place twice, Fayston Math Competition

- A small group that met to work through problems none of us could finish alone.
- What it built was patience rather than speed. Staying with one problem much longer than is comfortable is a skill, and it is the one that carried over into everything else here.
- Took 2nd place twice at the Fayston Math Competition.

Astronomy Club

Dec. 2025 – Present

Member

Observation and orbital mechanics

- Observation nights, plus the long arithmetic that sits behind them.
- Orbital mechanics is mechanical engineering at a scale nobody lets you touch, so the model you build is the only instrument you have. That is a good reason to get it right.

ATHLETICS

Basketball, Varsity and Junior Varsity

Oct. 2024 – Present

About 3 hours per week

2nd place, KISAC Tournament

- Started on junior varsity. Named captain, then team MVP, then moved up to varsity. Two years so far, three hours a week, without a season off.
- The varsity team finished 2nd at the KISAC tournament.
- Being captain is the part that changed me. Running a huddle for players who are tired and behind on the scoreboard is a different job from being good at basketball, and it is the skill I use most when I am on a build team.

MUSIC

Fayston Symphony Orchestra

Aug. 2025 – Jun. 2026

Full concert season

Rehearsal through performance

- A full season of rehearsal ending in concert performance.
- Eighty people, one tempo, and no room for a private interpretation. It is the clearest system I have been part of, and it taught me that being precise is a way of respecting everyone else in the room.

Church Orchestra

Feb. 2026 – Present

About 1 hour per week

Every Sunday

- Playing for the congregation every Sunday. No audition, no ranking, no award at the end of it.

- It is the one commitment on this page that nobody is keeping score of, which is exactly why I keep doing it.

Concert Band

School course

Course Excellence award

Awarded for the year

- Received the Course Excellence award for the year.

SERVICE

Hiking Heroes

About 2 hours per week for fifteen months

Mar. 2024 – Jun. 2025

Campus and trail cleanup

- Fifteen months of cleaning the campus and the trails around it. Repetitive, unglamorous work, and the reason the sentence *someone should fix that* stopped sounding acceptable to me.
- The group also took part in a forum on climate change and Silhak, the Korean tradition of practical learning, which holds that knowledge is worth what it changes. That is the closest thing I have found to a description of why I want to be an engineer.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **Student of the Month**, Fayston Preparatory School
- **Fayston Math Competition, 2nd Place**, awarded twice
- **Fayston Engineering Competition, 2nd Place**, Engineering Club
- **KISAC Tournament, 2nd Place**, Varsity Basketball
- **Junior Varsity MVP and Captain**, Basketball
- **Course Excellence, Concert Band**, academic award